

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 2
 ♥ K J 8 5
 ♦ J 8 7 4
 ♣ 10 6 3

♠ A J 7 4

♥ 10 9 6

♦ Q 5

♣ A K 8 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 9 8

♥ A Q 3

♦ 10 9 6 3 2

♣ 9 7

♠ Q 6 5 3

♥ 7 4 2

♦ A K

♣ Q J 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ 5			

South is to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♥ 5. The defense wins 3 ♥ tricks, then switches to a ♦.

Losers: ♠ = ? ♥ = 3 ♦ = 0 ♣ = 0 Total = 3 ?

You have already lost the 3 ♥ tricks so you must pick up the trump suit without loss. The odds aren't in your favor, but you have no choice but to play West for the doubleton King.

Lead a small ♠ from your hand and when West plays low put on the ♠ J. When this holds the trick plunk down the ♠ A and hope.

This position is one that is misplayed very often.

Look what would have occurred if you had started with the ♠ Q. West would have covered with the ♠ K (if he had it) and you would have lost a trick to the ♠ 10 later.

The only hope is to try to drop the ♠ K without wasting an extra honor.

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 7
 ♥ 10 5 3
 ♦ A K 10 6
 ♣ Q 6

♠ 8 6 2

♥ A Q

♦ 9 7 5 4

♣ 8 5 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 10 5 4 3

♥ 6

♦ 8 3 2

♣ K 9 7 4

♠ A

♥ K J 9 8 7 4 2

♦ Q J

♣ A J 10

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1♥
Pass	1NT	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♦ A			

South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♦ A. The defenders take two ♦ tricks, then switch to a trump.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=2 Total = 4

The status is pretty clear, you've already lost the 2 ♦s so you have to keep your ♣ losers to just one. You have a good chance of pulling that off by playing for the ♣K and ♣Q to lie in different hands and taking two finesses.

But you will only be in dummy once more so you **MUST** make the first finesse right now. Play a small ♣ from dummy and play the ♣10. West wins with the ♣Q and plays another trump.

In dummy for the last time you must now take your second ♣ finesse. You play a small ♣ to your ♣J. When the ♣J wins you pull any leftover trumps and your hand is good.

This Deal is an excellent example of how and when to use the Double-Finesse, which gives you a 75% chance of success.

It was probably a better example of watching your entries. If you had pulled another trump before taking that first ♣ finesse you would not have been able to take the second one.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 6
♥ Q 4 3 2
♦ 5
♣ K Q 10 4 2

♠ 7 4 3

♥ J 6

♦ A J 10 7 2

♣ 8 7 6



♠ J 10 9 2

♥ 10 9 8

♦ 4

♣ A J 9 5 3

♠ A Q 5

♥ A K 7 5

♦ K Q 9 8 6 3

♣ —

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1 ♦
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	5 ♦	Pass	6 ♦
All Pass			
6 ♦ by South			
Lead: ♣K			

♥J, then a ♠ back to your ♠A. Discard dummy's 2 ♠ losers on the ♥ A K and claim your slam.

Suppose that it was East who held the ♥Q. Your ♥J would have been taken and you wouldn't get the two ♠ discards.

Then you would have to rely on the ♠ finesse after all. You'd be no worse off because you could still discard one of dummy's ♠s on a big ♥.

This method of play gave you two chances instead of just one.

South is to play 6 ♦. West leads the ♣K.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=0 Total = 4

You don't really have 2 ♥ losers since both of them can be ruffed in dummy. The 2 ♠ losers are real, though, and must be dealt with. If East holds the ♠K then a simple finesse will win the contract for you. A 50% chance. But there is more to this Deal than a simple finesse, look at it carefully.

In addition to the trumps, dummy has another useful card, the ♥J. You can give yourself a second chance by playing West to hold the ♥Q.

Ruff the opening ♣ lead, pull trumps with the ♦K, (they split 1-1), and play a low ♥ toward the ♥J. West fidgets, then puts on the ♥Q and plays another ♣ which you ruff.

You are in control now. You play a ♥ to dummy's

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 2

♥ Q 6 3

♦ 9 5 3

♣ 8 4 3

♠ K J 7

♥ K 7

♦ A J 10 8

♣ K J 9 6



♠ 6 4

♥ 10 9 5 4 2

♦ 7 6 4 2

♣ Q 5

♠ A Q 5 3

♥ A J 8

♦ K Q

♣ A 10 7 2

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by South			
Lead: ♠ 10			

South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♠ 10.

Winners: ♠=4 ♥=2 ♦=4 ♣=2 Total = 12

A. Conan Doyle would have called this "The Tale of Two Queens". You need to find one more trick and to do so you are going to have to find either the ♥Q or the ♣Q. You can finesse East for the ♥Q, and you can finesse either defender for the ♣Q.

So which will you choose?

Neither, yet. First take your 8 winners in ♠s and ♦s, hoping somebody discards something to help you. They don't.

Now play the ♣A, then ♣K, hoping the ♣Q falls. If she does you have your thirteenth trick in ♣s. If she doesn't you take the ♥K then finesse East for the ♥Q. Two chances.

As you see, the ♥ finesse would have failed. You might have guessed the ♣Q correctly, but you might not have.

It always pays to look for a second chance. Here you try to drop the ♣Q, and if it doesn't work you have the finesse for the ♥Q in reserve.

Why not try to drop the ♥Q and keep the finesse for the ♣Q in reserve? Because you and dummy had 8 ♣s between you and only 6 ♥s. So the ♣Q was far more likely to be doubleton than the ♥Q.